

Dana Atchley Merrick

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HIGHLIGHTS

- Technology generalist with deep understanding of full stack
- Detail-oriented, level-headed, and motivated problem solver
- Approachable engineer with whom colleagues genuinely enjoy working
- Track record as first infra hire, inheriting homegrown infra & modernizing it

EXPERIENCE

Principal DevOps Engineer 2024-25

Ginkgo Bioworks (YC S14), Boston, MA

- Spearheaded company-wide migration from AWS to GCP, building greenfield GCP infrastructure with cross-cloud connectivity to existing AWS systems.
- Built an external-facing ML model serving platform end-to-end on GKE, including API gateway, auto-scaling, GPU metrics, and OpenTelemetry tracing.
- Designed multi-tenant Kubernetes infrastructure serving 6+ teams with isolated namespaces, service accounts, and data access controls.
- Stood up GKE platforms from scratch across multiple GCP projects using Terraform and Tanka/Jsonnet-based GitOps.
- Developed self-service developer tooling including Streamlit apps for VM management, CLI tools, and pipelines with GitLab CI.

Staff Software Engineer

2020-24

Reverie Labs (YC W18), Cambridge, MA (acquired by Ginkgo)

- Joined as the company's first infrastructure engineer, inheriting a single manually-managed AWS account and building it into a multi-account, Terraform-managed platform.
- Managed EKS clusters through 10 Kubernetes version upgrades, deploying services such as MLflow, Argo Workflows, JupyterHub, and Prometheus/Grafana.
- Facilitated large-scale ML workflows on GPU compute (AWS Batch, Kubernetes) for computational drug discovery in partnership with Roche.
- Built CI/CD pipeline on GitHub Actions with ChatOps deployment, nightly test suites, and multi-image Docker builds for scientific computing tools.

Senior Engineer

2019-20

Postmates, San Francisco, CA

- Led infrastructure efforts for Postmates' "delivery as a service" developer API.
- Implemented server functionality in Go – including adding metrics, logging, tracing, and new features.
- Worked on build process and deploy pipeline using Docker and Kubernetes.
- Served as liaison between developer API team and the greater Postmates infrastructure team.
- Selected to lead the company-wide migration from AWS to GCP.

Senior Infrastructure Engineer

2016-18

Snapdocs (YC W14), San Francisco, CA

- Full ownership of the infrastructure: security, performance, reliability, cost, architecture, testing, tooling, documentation, and more.
- Created a suite of internal tools to assist with development, testing, deployment, and administration.
- Migrated from AWS OpsWorks to Elastic Beanstalk using CloudFormation.
- Oversaw a SOC 2 audit.
- Served as a mentor/educator to entire engineering team.

Senior Infrastructure Engineer 2015-16
Plaid, San Francisco, CA

- Designed a Vagrant developer environment that utilized the same Chef infrastructure code as the production environment.
- Designed and implemented a system to run integration testing suite against every pull request, catching many bugs before they were deployed.
- Created a GitHub Enterprise server and migrated all private repositories/users.
- Moved a manually-maintained Nagios alerting system to one fully automated with Chef.
- Developed countless internal tools to assist with development, testing, and deployment.
- Upgraded massive production MongoDB server cluster to the latest version with zero downtime.

Lead Infrastructure Engineer 2014-15
IFTTT, San Francisco, CA

- Sole infrastructure engineer responsible for servers on AWS and Heroku.
- Managed a sophisticated job queuing system using Resque/Redis, directing API traffic across nearly 200 different APIs.
- Improved stability of deploy process; reduced the total deploy time by 50%.
- Prepared for and oversaw the system during the launch of the Do apps – the company’s biggest launch to date, involving global press coverage and millions of new users.

Platform Engineer 2011-14
Brightcove / Zencoder (YC W10), San Francisco, CA

- Led the team responsible for replacing Brightcove’s transcoding stack with Zencoder infrastructure.
- Maintained build farm, Postgres/MongoDB databases, Riak servers, Nagios systems, and Resque queues.
- Automated machine image builds with Packer and modernized Chef infrastructure.

EDUCATION *Trinity College, Hartford, CT* 2010
Bachelor of Science, Double Major
Computer Science & Classical Mathematics

PORTFOLIO My GitHub account has many public repositories for you to browse.
The most up-to-date version of this résumé can also be found there.
You may find it at github.com/dmerrick.

LOOKING FOR Early-stage teams solving hard problems in interesting domains.
A culture of trust, ownership, and room to build.
Meaningful work where engineering effort translates to real-world impact.

REFERENCES Available upon request.